



Gaming Laptops

We live in a world where ultrabooks are fast pushing out the last remnants of entities what were once known as laptops or notebooks. Just like in the human world, where fat bodies are frowned upon and anorexic figures celebrated, ultrabooks are the 'it' machines of mobile computing and good ol' flabby laptops have few takers these days. However, making wafer-thin ultrabooks has its physical limitations – for packing in an unbeatable arsenal of hardware firepower is next to impossible on an ultrabook form factor, currently. And this is where gaming laptops buck the trend, for as a thumb rule the more chunkier, larger a gaming laptop is, the better its internal hardware muscle invariably is.

Sadly, there hasn't been too much action in the gaming laptops scene this year, with the same old players refreshing their flagship product offerings. We're happy to report that gaming laptops haven't lost any of their unique qualities that make them so special – ostentatious design, cutting edge hardware, and some serious gaming bling. It's good to see Intel's "Haswell" processors making their way into these high-powered machines, while NVIDIA mobile GPUs continue to dominate the high-end mobile gaming market – AMD's had a forgettable year on PC gaming until their Hawaiian Islands GPU refresh last month, and there's still some time before we start seeing laptops sporting their spiffy new GPUs. Razer's mobile gaming rig still isn't available for purchase here in India and



Alienware 17

Price: ₹1,29,990

MSI's inconspicuous absence means that there isn't much competition.

Zero1 Winner ASUS ROG G750JX

The ASUS Republic of Gamers G750JX came out in front of the Alienware 17 by a very close margin. This 17-inch gaming behemoth isn't quite as spectacular as the Alienware in terms of looks and glam factor, but its built very well and has some impressive hardware: a quad-core Intel Core i7-4700MQ chip, 16GB RAM, 1.5 TB HDD, and NVIDIA GTX 770M (3GB GDDR5 VRAM), that conquers any latest game with ease. Despite sporting identical battery capacity, the ASUS gaming laptop lasted about 23 mins more than the Alienware 17 in our synthetic benchmark carried out at identical settings. And the slightly superior GPU that ASUS G750JX sports definitely helps it gain an edge over the Alienware 17.

Besides the obvious gaming firepower, the G750JX has a nice wide backlit keyboard deck and a slightly larger touchpad area compared to the Alienware. Audio visual performance of the machine while watching HD 1080p rips or Blu-ray movies was top notch, no complaints whatsoever. What's more, this machine is 3D ready, letting you watch stereoscopic games or movies with a bundled pair of glasses and gaming headset.

Not far behind... Alienware 17

A huge part of the appeal of any Alienware machine is undoubtedly its look and feel. Past Alienwares have sported some iconic designs and bling, and the new Alienware 17 continues the tradition. Sporting a metal screen lid with angular accents, and a nice chunky reinforced plastic exterior, the Alienware feels rock solid and very sturdy. The overdose of glowing LED bits -- right from the logo to the keyboard keys -- and angular edges on the Alienware gives it a distinct personality that's quite unique. The keyboard is good for both typing and gaming (not quite in the same league as mechanical keyboards, though), and its touchpad is nice and textured. Apart from boasting off a Full HD matte screen display, another highlight of the Alienware 17 is its better-than-average onboard audio. This machine marginally loses out to the ASUS gaming rig due to a slightly lesser GPU, otherwise it has the same basic hardware specs. This is still a winner in our books, packing in unmatched bling for gamers looking for a distinctive gaming laptop.



ASUS ROG G750JX
Price: ₹1,49,999